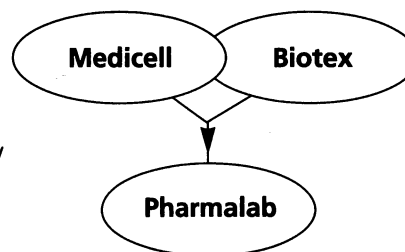


Pharmalab: Student B

Worksheet

Journalist

A recent merger in the pharmaceuticals industry



You are a journalist writing an article about a new pharmaceutical company called Pharmalab. Make a telephone call to a representative of Pharmalab, using the questions below to help you. Make some notes during the call.

1 Management culture

Medicell had a centralized management structure in which Head Office controlled everything. Biotex was decentralized. What will be the culture at Pharmalab? Will there be problems for the two groups of staff who now have to work together?

2 Product range

Medicell and Biotex seemed to have a different approach to their product range. What was the difference? What will be Pharmalab's approach?

3 Partnerships

Medicell had several strong partnerships with biotechnology companies, while Biotex had little interest in forming partnerships. What will Pharmalab do?

4 Current situation

Find out more about these three points:

- The patent on their best selling drug, Diasin, just ended. What effect will this have?
- Do they have any new products?
- How many employees will lose their jobs as a result of the merger?

5 Pharmalab's sales

The main sectors in the pharmaceuticals market are listed below. Which are the most important sectors for Pharmalab?

- Medicines sold to doctors and hospitals
- Products sold in pharmacies without a doctor's prescription
- Vision care: glasses, contact lenses etc.

6 Future strategy

What is Pharmalab's strategy for the future?